Leveraging Sustainability Perceptions

The Role of Branding

Why Sustainability Matters

- Core decision factor
- Competition on values
- Trust & loyalty
- Digital oversight

Sustainability to Regenerative

- Sustainability – reducing harm
- Regenerative - Net Positive impact
- Visitors as co-contributors

The Three Pillars

- Environmental – Biodiversity, climate, resource use
- Economic – Local livelihoods fair benefit distribution
- Socio-cultural – Heritage protection

Research Trends

- Sustainability central in Brand Identity research
- Rapid growth since 2018
- Interdisciplinary approach

What Works in Green Branding

- Evidence-based claims
- Transparency
- 3rd-party certification
- Visitor participation

Tripadvisor
Travelers' Choice Awards
2025

Regenerative Narratives

- Emphasis on net-positive
- Transparency
- 3rd-party certification
- Visitor participation

The Credibility Destroyers

- Vague language
- Lack of data
- Claims vs images
- Negative media
- Martketing add-on

Greenwashing Clues

- No evidence
- Misleading images
- Broad claims
- Avoidance of issues

Avoiding Greenwashing

- Publish transparent reports
- Use independent audits
- Acknowledge limitations
- Include local voices

Building Visitor Trust

- Consistency across touchpoints
- Transparency
- Authenticity
- Demonstrate responsiveness

Digital Tools

- Immersive storytelling
- Real-time dashboards
- Social media transparency
- UGC validated claims
- Interactive maps

Sustainability Framework

- Define priorities
- Measure impact
- Engage stakeholders
- Create authentic story
- Validate by certification
- Communicate transparently
- Evolve continuously